



Managing Emotions

Imagine a client calls you and tells you the project you have been working on for 6 months is cancelled:



What Emotions, Thoughts, Physical Feelings and Behaviours would you experience?

Emotions:

Thoughts:

Physical Feelings:

Behaviours:



How could you better manage this emotional response in future?



UNDERSTANDING AND MANAGING EMOTIONS

Best Practice



Own Your Emotions

You cannot influence how others behave, you CAN influence / control your emotional response.



Know Your Emotional Triggers

Develop strategies to respond consciously and purposefully rather than automatically.



Manage The Physical Feelings

Practice slow breathing, count to ten, go for a brisk walk, listen to music.



Reflect On What Went Wrong

How can you respond in a more appropriate way in future?



Remember To Stop And Think

Is your default response correct? How will you feel about the situation tomorrow? (example- writing an angry email in response to something at work).



Consciously Decide How To React

If you miss out on a promotion, you can either complain OR you can ask for feedback.



Be Assertive When Necessary

Be assertive where achieving a specific outcome is important to you, but accept that there are probable risks and consequences of your assertion, including making things worse.



Develop Positive Thinking

Acknowledge the difficulties in a situation but focus on the good things, see the best in others, be positive about yourself, your abilities and emotions, and nurture positive 'self-talk'.

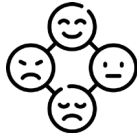


UNDERSTANDING AND MANAGING EMOTIONS | EXERCISE 1

Example Answers



What Emotions, Thoughts, Physical Feelings and Behaviours would you experience?



EMOTIONS

You might react angrily



THOUGHTS

"What a waste of my time"



PHYSICAL FEELINGS

Tension, accelerated breathing, over-heating

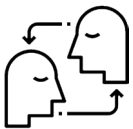


BEHAVIOURS

Complain loudly to colleagues, manager or customer



How could you better manage this emotional response in future?



ACKNOWLEDGE YOUR AND OTHERS' FEELINGS

Understand that the cancellation can't have been easy for the client either and react accordingly. Take a moment to gather your thoughts and control the physical feelings before responding, (use breathing techniques if that helps). The outcome you require is to remain on good terms with this customer.



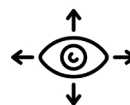
THINK POSITIVE

Rather than feeling frustrated or disappointed, take the positives from this -all your hard work will not go to waste since you have learnt a great deal throughout the process and can apply it to other projects.



BE PRAGMATIC

The project may be reinstated as has happened previously with this client.



GAIN PERSPECTIVE

You have built good relationships with this client and have been part of a large multidisciplinary team. This will stand you in good stead for acquiring future work from the original client or via other project members.